

GEOGRAPHY

PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY



CLIMATOLOGY

MODULE – 34

WORLD CLIMATIC TYPES
THE HOT DESERT AND MID-LATITUDE
DESERT CLIMATES (PART-2)

WORLD CLIMATIC TYPES

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS



1 Bedouin Arabs have fared quite well with their flocks of sheep, goats, camels and horses.

2 The Bushmen of the Kalahari and the Bindibu of Australia remain so primitive in their mode of living that they barely survive.

3 They are, in fact, a relic of the Old Stone age in the modern world. The desert inhabitants may be grouped under the following categories

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

1

THE PRIMITIVE HUNTERS & COLLECTORS



1

Of the primitive tribes, the Bushmen and the Bindibu are the best known.

2

Both the tribes are nomadic hunters and food gatherers, growing no crops and domesticating no animals.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

1

THE PRIMITIVE HUNTERS & COLLECTORS

BUSHMEN

1

The Bushmen roam the Kalahari Desert with their bows and poisoned arrows, spears, traps and snares.



2

They are not only skilful and strong but have great endurance.

3

In order to capture their prey, they have to be very patient and if necessary run many miles to track down the wounded animals.

4

Great skill is required in obtaining water in the desert. Dew is carefully gathered from leaves early in the morning and stored in ostrich shells.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

1

THE PRIMITIVE HUNTERS & COLLECTORS

BUSHMEN



5

Very often, it is necessary to dig a hole in damp sand and **suck the water up from the ground through a hallow reed**. This is often a very slow process.

6

Bushmen either **wear a loin cloth** or go **virtually naked**.

7

They travel in small family groups, and live together in open **shrams**. This is a hollow dig beneath a thorn tree, surrounded by bushes. At night a fire is lit to keep the family warm.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

1

THE PRIMITIVE HUNTERS & COLLECTORS



BINDIBU

1

The Bindibu or Aborigines of Australia live in very much the same way as the Bushmen.

2

They are lean and dark but healthy. They are skilled trackers and some of them use wooden throwing sticks or boomerangs and spears.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

1

THE PRIMITIVE HUNTERS & COLLECTORS



BINDIBU

3

They also domesticate the *dingo, a wild dog* that assists them in tracking down kangaroos, rabbits, birds.

4

Like the wandering bushmen, the Bindibu move in family groups in search of fresh hunting grounds.

5

But one distinct difference is that they always stay close to a water supply as they still have not devised a means of tapping and storing water

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

2

THE NOMADIC HERDSMEN



ZERIBA GRASS

1

These people represent a more advanced group of desert dwellers who pursue a livestock economy.

2

They ride on animals instead of walking and are heavily clad against the blazing sun, the stormy winds and the chilly nights.

3

The Bedouin of Arabia and the Tuaregs of the Sahara are camel riders and dwell in grass zeriba, while the Gobi Mongols ride on horses to herd their yaks and live in portable yurts (a kind of tent).

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

2

THE NOMADIC HERDSMEN

BEDOUIN

1

The Bedouin are the best example of desert groups who have **fared well as nomadic herdsmen**.

2

Besides keeping large flocks of animals, they are also engaged in trade with the caravan merchants and the oases people.

3

All round the year, the Bedouin wander with their herds in search of water and green pastures.



3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

2

THE NOMADIC HERDSMEN

BEDOUIN

4

Their **wealth is their animals**: sheep, goats camels and perhaps a few horses.



5

The animals provide them with all that they require, daily milk and cheese and on occasions meat as well.

6

Their skin is used for hides or leather, for making tents, clothing, belts, footwear and water bags. From the hair and wool, the Bedouin make clothes, mats, ropes, rugs and carpets.

7

These **can also be exchanged** at trading stations or oases for other necessities of life.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

2

THE NOMADIC HERDSMEN

BEDOUIN



7

The Bedouin move in groups of about a hundred. They follow a regular pattern of routes along which are patches of pastures, wells or springs.

8

In this manner, one group rarely clashes with the other in their search for new grounds to pitch their tents.

9

Since they move so often, they always travel light and only the essentials are carried along.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

3

THE CARAVAN TRADERS



1

These were the *travelling merchants* of the desert. Their journeys across the lands of the Sahara or Russian Turkestan sometimes lasted months or even years.

2

They travelled at night as a team and were well armed. They carried a wide range of goods into remote interiors where their merchandise was highly sought after.

3

The pack-animal used by the caravans to carry their goods across the deserts was the *camel*, aptly described as the “Ship of the Desert”.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

3

THE CARAVAN TRADERS

4

Unlike horses which have sharp hooves that sink readily in the sandy desert, the camel has broad padded feet that will not slip in the sand.



3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

3

THE CARAVAN TRADERS

5

The camel has several other advantages. It provides milk and hair. It can store water in its stomach and fat in its hump, so that it can go for long periods without either food or water.

6

With the introduction of modern air, road and rail transport, the role of the caravan traders is greatly reduced.



3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

4

THE SETTLED CULTIVATORS

- 1** For crops to be cultivated in the desert, irrigation is indispensable. This is obtained either from oases, rivers or dams through a network of canals



- 2** In Egypt, the Nile supports a population of 25 million, mainly concentrated in the Nile valley and delta.

- 3** When the Nile flooded in summer, the overflowed water was caught in basins with raised banks and led into the fields to irrigate the crops.

- 4** This was **basin irrigation**, which was widely practised by the ancient Egyptian farmers and is still employed by the Egyptians today.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

4

THE SETTLED CULTIVATORS



ASWAN DAM IN NILE

4

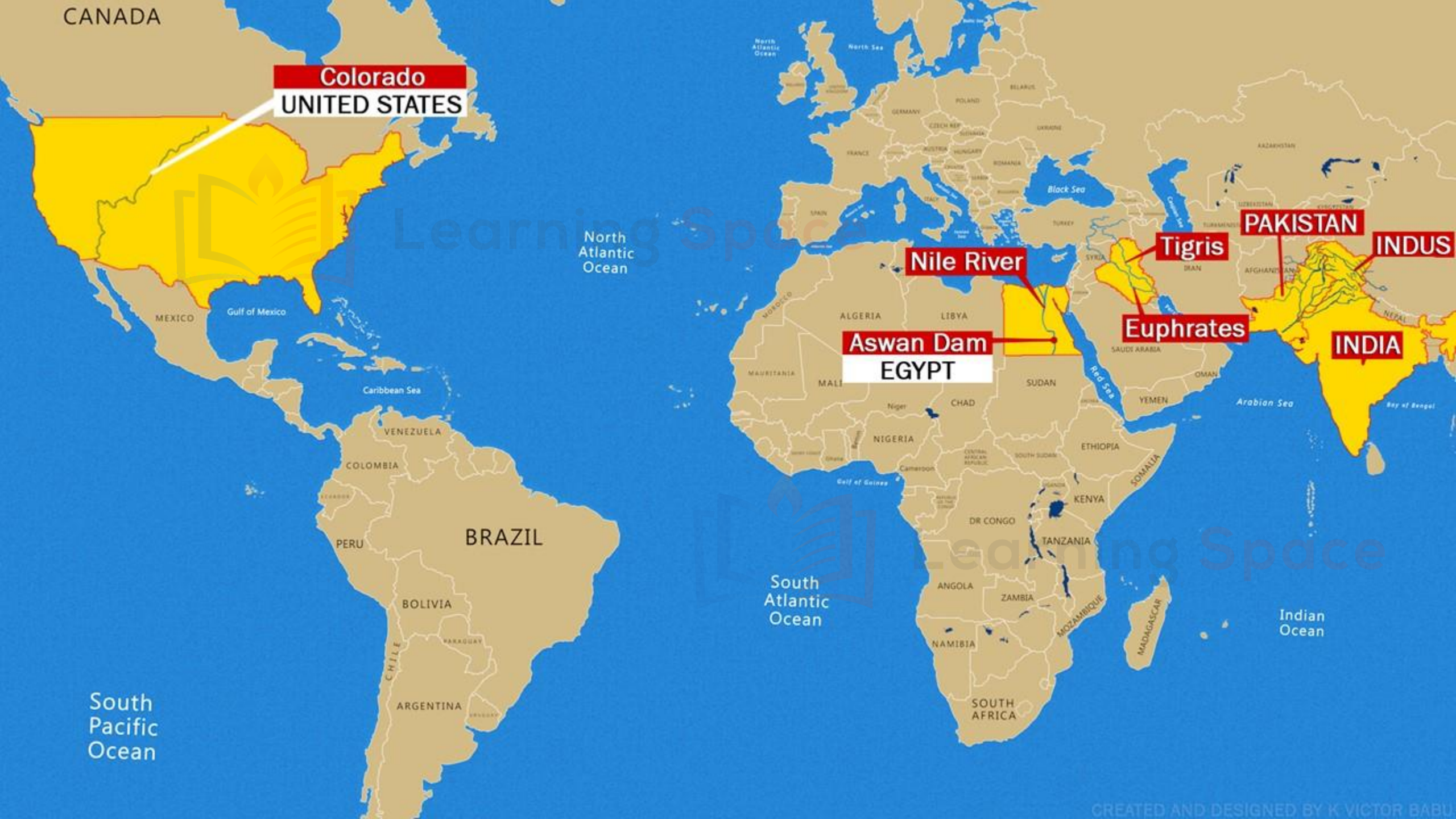
Rice and cotton are cultivated in summer, followed by wheat, barley, beans and other minor crops in winter. Modern concrete dams constructed across the Nile e.g. Aswan and Sennar Dams are even more effective for extensive irrigation works.

5

The flood-water can be held back and controlled and then released at any part of the year to feed the fields that yield two, three or even more crops a year.

6

In the same way, desert cultivators rely on the Indus in Pakistan, the Tigris-Euphrates in Iraq and the Colorado in the Imperial Valley of California and are able to irrigate millions of acres of arid land for crop production.



Colorado
UNITED STATES

North Atlantic Ocean

Nile River

Aswan Dam
EGYPT

Tigris

Euphrates

PAKISTAN

INDUS

INDIA

South Atlantic Ocean

Indian Ocean

South Pacific Ocean

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

4

THE SETTLED CULTIVATORS

7

In the deserts, wherever there are oases, some form of settled life is bound to follow.



8

Life in an oasis is secure and well organized. A wall is usually constructed around the oasis to keep out the violent dust storms called *simooms*.



SIMOOM IN NUBRA VALLEY

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

4

THE SETTLED CULTIVATORS



9

The oasis people live in mud-brick houses with flat roofs, closely packed together.

10

The streets are narrow and winding, and the heart of the settlement is dominated by the suq (Central market place), the mosque, school and shopping blocks.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

4

THE SETTLED CULTIVATORS



10

Around the settlement are the agricultural lands. Water is led to the fields by irrigation channels or drawn up from wells by camels or mules.

11

The important tree is the date palm which is grown in dug-out hollows so that its roots can penetrate deep into the ground in search of water.

12

The fruit is consumed locally and also exported. Other crops cultivated include maize, barley, wheat, cotton, cane sugar, fruits and vegetables.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

5

THE MINING SETTLERS



GOLD IN QUARTZ

1

The lure of mineral wealth has attracted many immigrants into the desert.

2

Mining camps and isolated settlements have sprung up following the discovery of certain mineral deposits.

3

It was gold that brought immigrants scrambling into the Great Australian Desert.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

5

THE MINING SETTLERS



5

Some of them like Kalgoorlie and Coolgardie have become towns of considerable size. In the Kalahari Desert, the discovery of diamonds and copper has brought many white men to the “thirstland” as it is called.



AUSTRALIA

Coral Sea

Indian Ocean

Kalgoorlie

Great
Australian Bight

Coolgardie

TASMAN SEA

NEW ZEALAND

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

5

THE MINING SETTLERS

6

Even in the most arid Atacama, in northern Chile, large mining camps have been established for the mining of caliche (Cemented gravels) from which sodium nitrate, a valuable fertilizer, is extracted and exported to all parts of the world.



CALICHE MINING

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

5

THE MINING SETTLERS

7

Besides nitrates, copper is also mined. These two products have directly or indirectly contributed to the growing size of the Chilean towns of Africa, Iquique, Antofagasta and Chuquicamata.



South
Pacific
Ocean

IQUIQUE
CHUQUICAMATA

BOLIVIA

BRAZIL

PARAGUAY

ARGENTINA

URUGUAY

Learning Space



3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

5

THE MINING SETTLERS



8

Similarly in the deserts of North America, silver is mined in Mexico, uranium in Utah and copper in Nevada.

9

In recent years, the discovery of oil, in many parts of the Saharan and Arabian Desert has transformed this forgotten part of the globe.

3

HOT DESERT AND MIDLATITUDE DESERT CLIMATES

LIFE IN THE DESERTS

5

THE MINING SETTLERS



10

In Algeria, oil wells have been sunk two miles deep to tap oil. In the Middle East, pipelines over 1,000 miles long have been laid to bring oil from the shores of the Persian Gulf across Saudi Arabia (Lebanon) and Baniyas (Syria) on the Mediterranean coast.

11

With still half of the world's reserves of oil untapped in this region, the deserts here will virtually be paved with gold! In Iraq, Kuwait and Saudi Arabia the desert landscape is fast changing.

12

New roads, huge palaces, ultra-modern hospitals, air-conditioned apartments and swimming pools are examples of a thriving new era created entirely by oil-“Liquid Gold”.

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For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao
K. Srikanth
D. Sunil Kumar
L. V. Krishna
D. Chaitanya

Amrita Naidu
M. Binukrishna
G. Ravi Babu
D. Joji
K. Victor Babu

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